

Muscular Moe Boosted In National Writeup

Emil Panko, whose average has slipped a bit of late, but is still well over .300, is in the running for Southern League "rookie of the year" laurels according to thinking in that area voiced sportswriter Bill Keefe of New Orleans in a feature on Emil in the Sporting News this week.

The article hardly sounds accurate in all departments, but essentially is quite a nice, splashy writeup for the young Yonkers hopeful in a hurry. Andy Cohen, his Pelicans' manager, says the best part about Emil is his disposition.

"He likes to go to bed early and get up early so he can think about baseball and talk about it. He's about as serious a twenty-one-year-old as I've ever handled and he would like to play 10 hours a day."

If this is the impression Emil has life since returning to the Pelicans it is certainly a gold star in his favor.

Emil, who grew overweight to about 200 or more pounds in the off-season, has worked himself, as he said he would, into solid shape.

According to Keefe "he's built along the lines of Hack Wilson and looks more like a Herculean guard on a football team." He is otherwise referred to as extremely powerfully built.

"He is a hard worker," Cohen says, "and probably won't pick up much more weight. His wide shoulders and deep chest make him look shorter than he is, but he's five feet, 11, and I don't think he'll ever weigh more than 190 pounds."

The writeup says that Panko played basketball, baseball and football during his high school career, starring in football as well as baseball. He did play football his senior year at Saunders, playing some fullback, and he was All-City calibre in baseball and basketball.

The writeup compares Emil for explosive right-handed power to Brjs Lord, an old-time SA hero.

He is reported as fast as any man on his team, able to cover ground, a keen ball hawk with a powerful and accurate arm. According to Keefe he takes a murderous cut at the ball, but in spite of his heavy arms and shoulders, his swing is smooth and flat and he doesn't get off balance. He is credited with a great eye and almost perfect timing.

His swing is compared with Rogers Hornsby and his build with Mickey Mantle. He is credited with the ability to hit righthanders as well as left-handers.

Cohen rates Panko almost a sure shot to make the major leagues next year and the report is that Branch Rickey Jr., rating him potentially another Ralph Kiner, is disinclined to trade or sell him.

It's certainly a complimentary writeup to the young man.

John Valmas of Bronxville, a pitcher, has been optioned from Chattanooga of the Double-A Southern Association to Thibodaux, which must be somewhere, but is not listed in the official directory of league and clubs in organized baseball from A to D.

B.L.

Irish Warmup For City Track

Sacred Heart's track team warmed up for Friday afternoon's city meet at Glen Park by trimming Concordia Prep, 49-28, at Bronxville High yesterday.

Brian Campanaro won the 220 in 24.6 and John Hoar the half in 2:02.6 and then they tied in the high jump at 5-6. Bill Smith won the quarter in 54.9 and Don Fredeman the mile in 4:52. The Irish relayists won. Concordia victors included Miller in a 10.9 century and Dick Eggers with a 19-11 1/2 broad jump.

Gorton Netters Bow To Davis By 3-2

Coach Alfred DeNisco's Gorton tennis team, which beat Yonkers, 3-2, last week, absorbed its first loss at Trevor Park, yesterday, to Davis, 3-2, with the doubles matches decisive.

DAVIS 3, GORTON 2

Frank Diller (G) d. Darron Norman (D), 6-0, 6-0; Peter Marcus (D) d. Cormac Ryan (G), 7-5, 6-1; Richard Rashum (G) d. Richard Fishbein (D), 6-0, 6-3; Jay Gariand and Harvey Sandy (D) d. David Henderson and Peter Cesarowski (G), 6-2, 6-4; Steve Cline and Steve Davis (D) d. Robin Boone and Robert Benson (G), 6-0, 6-1.

GORTON SLATE

May 15—Roosevelt, 22—at White Plains, 24—at Bronxville, 29—Mamaroneck; JUNE 5—New Rochelle, 8—Yonkers. Home games at Trevor Park.

SCHOOL TENNIS

H. Greeley 4, Rye 1
New Rochelle 3, Mamaroneck 2
Ossining 3, C. Harmon 2
Peekskill 4, Beacon 0